crushed and disillusioned," Max reports on all of the ups and downs in his work.

Last year things started to happen for Max. One of his pieces 'Rise of the Machines' was juried in to the 'Rising' exhibition held by the American Association of Woodturners (AAW) at the Phoenix symposium. Later that year, he was fortunate enough to have two pieces bought by The Daniel Collection at the National Woodturning Seminar, in Ireland. On that same occasion, Max won 1st and 2nd prizes in the Artistic category and 2nd prize in the Open category of the competition, which came as an overwhelming surprise for the woodworker. This year his piece 'Freedom of Speech' was juried into the Professional Outreach Program (POP) exhibition of the AAW symposium in Pittsburgh. "I've been very lucky," Max reflects back on his year.

As for low points, Max tells us: "I have to say the frustration of not having the right equipment, or the money to buy it ranks highly." For a long time Max had no chuck and a very bad lathe that only vibrated. "Then," he continues, "there's putting countless hours into a piece, only to break it when you're just about done. But after some choice words, some deep breaths and a cup of tea, this usually turns out to be a great learning experience."

Max looks to what he thinks is the best thing about turning, saying: "turning is an amazing outlet for creative and artistic energy and I feel very fortunate to be here at this stage in the evolution of turning. The pioneering work has been done, especially in the USA, in the effort to have turning recognised as an art form.

"Galleries are more open to turned artwork, some even specialise in turned work. Great tools and equipment are readily available and it is getting easier by the minute for people to get into turning with large scale symposia, books, videos, and classes available."

The future

Max feels his work is developing in two directions: "I'm working on building a large enough body of work that I can supply galleries with." Max been invited to exhibit at a gallery show called FORM + DESIGN this November in Dortmund, Germany and he'd like to do more of this kind of work. At the same time Max loves passing on his skills and he looks forward to running classes from the new workshop. "I've had quite a few requests for instructional videos on my multi-axis hollow forms, so in time that's an avenue I'd like to go down too. I enjoy demonstrating and I love to demonstrate abroad in the future."

Max wants to continue developing his work and exploring ideas for as long as he enjoys it, while selling enough pieces through galleries to make a living. ●

Rise of the machines

Tetrahedron

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